

May 15, 2026

Supernova Externship Program Overview

Mike provided an overview of the upcoming externship program with Supernova, an insurance company. He explained the structure of the program, including the number and frequency of meetings, and introduced participants to key insurance concepts and terminology. Mike outlined the different parties involved in property and casualty insurance, including insurers, reinsurers, managing general underwriters (MGUs), brokers, and agents. He emphasized the importance of understanding Supernova's perspective as an MGU and the regulatory environment in Canada. The discussion touched on how this knowledge would be applied to analyzing the dataset from Supernova, which participants will examine through the lens of the insurance industry.

Insurance Risk Assessment and Underwriting

Mike explained the concepts of risk assessment and underwriting in the insurance industry, emphasizing their importance in determining which customers to insure and at what premium. He discussed how insurance companies assess risks based on data, such as traffic tickets, and outlined strategies like denying coverage or increasing premiums for higher-risk applicants. The discussion also covered the role of deductibles in both premiums and claims, with an example of how a high deductible affects insurance coverage and costs. High risk → high premium

Insurance Concepts and Coverage Explained

The meeting focused on explaining insurance concepts, particularly how deductibles and coverage limits work. Patrice explained that higher deductibles result in lower premiums, similar to how mortgage rates work with larger deposits. Mike detailed how insurance premiums are broken down into multiple coverage types, including general liability, commercial property, professional liability, cyber liability, and business interruption coverage. The discussion concluded with an explanation that annual revenue is a key factor in determining business interruption coverage payouts, which is why Supernova only insures businesses with less than \$2 million in annual revenue.

Supernova Externship Program Planning

The meeting focused on planning an externship program with Supernova, an AI insurance company. Mike explained the structure of the program, which involves three main topics: revenue analysis, AI risk assessment evaluation, and customer journey analysis. The team agreed to meet on Mondays, Wednesdays, and Fridays at 7 PM Eastern time for approximately 5 weeks. Mike outlined the deliverable requirements, including answering 40 pre-formulated questions and potentially presenting the findings. The group discussed scheduling challenges due to different time zones, and Mike assured participants that attending at least two out of three meetings would be sufficient for completion.

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Access to the EDA sheet: EDA Supernova Data Sheet Help

[Rates.ca](https://rates.ca) is the *front office* and Supernova is the *back office*

- Supernova is the supplier of insurance, they assess and price the risk, then give the premium.
- Rates.ca (a major Canadian digital insurance rate comparison platform → license broker) correlates with Supernova MGU (a digital commercial Managing General Underwriter) through a strategic partnership in the Canadian insurance market (Google).
 - **Lead Generation:** Rates.ca allows small-to-medium enterprise (SME) owners and commercial clients to shop around and apply for business insurance online.
 - **Underwriting Processing:** Instead of Rates.ca writing the policy, they pass the commercial applicant's details to Supernova. Supernova MGU then utilizes its digital platform to quote, process, and bind the policy on behalf of insurance carriers.
 - **The Relationship:** Rates.ca acts as the consumer-facing comparison portal, while Supernova MGU serves as the back-end tech and underwriting engine that fulfills the commercial product.

Data (Google Sheet)

Incomplete Stage

- Did the individual follow through and complete the insurance questions on rates.ca?

Source App

- LD :Lowest rates
- SN: Supernova
- RDC: [Rates.ca](https://rates.ca)

Category

- Categorizing of the company
 - Premiums are annual

Location could be the reason why coverage is not given, other factors like the consumer/customer choosing not to get the premium coverage.

Extended Business Interruption (EBI)

- pays for your lost business income during the slow period after you've reopened but haven't reached full sales yet.

Content Premium

- The specific price you pay to insure your personal belongings, like furniture and electronics, against damage or theft.

GL: General liability

On-Premises: on the premises/at the company

Business interruption: Any loss caused by a disaster or damage recovery, insurance will potentially pay the loss of income.

Rejection Log

- A **FUS grade (Fire Underwriters Survey)** is a ranking of how well a community can handle a fire, and it is a major reason properties end up on an insurance rejection log
 - The FUS grade ranks fire protection from 1 (best protection) to 10 (no protection); if your property is too far from a station, it receives a high grade like a 10.

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- This high grade often lands you on a rejection log, meaning insurers won't cover your business income (EBI) or belongings (Content Premium) because the risk of a total fire loss is too great.
- The 5-Mile Rule: Most standard insurers will reject a property if it is more than 5 miles from a responding fire station.
- High-Risk Log: If your property is too far away, it goes into a rejection log because the risk of a "total loss" (the building burning down completely before help arrives) is too high.
- Impact on EBI/Contents: If the building is rejected for fire risk, you typically cannot get the EBI (Business Interruption) or Content Premium coverage either, as they are usually "riders" attached to the main property policy (Google)

IBC Code

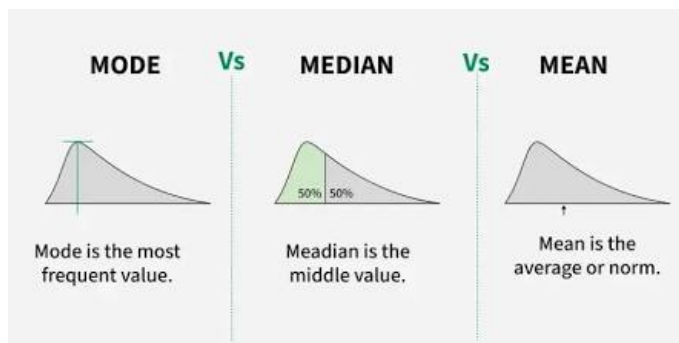
The IBC code (International Building Code) sets the standards for how a building is constructed to resist fire, and it works with the FUS grade to determine if you end up on a rejection log.

- The Building (IBC): If your building isn't built to IBC standards (e.g., lacks fire-rated walls or sprinklers), it becomes much harder to save during a fire.
- The Grade & Rejection: A poorly built building (IBC) in an area with a bad fire protection rank (FUS) creates a high "total loss" risk; this leads to an automatic rejection log entry where insurers refuse to cover your contents or lost income (EBI).
- IBC Code Finder: ibctool.supernovamgu.com (if red, rejected by supernova → and do not get quote).

JSON is a common unstructured data format used to store complex policy details (rejection log information)

TAM: Total Addressable Market

- If they miscategorize, the broker comes in and corrects what the AI may have misinterpreted.



Column

What it is

`incomplete_stage`

Where the user stopped in the quote flow (or "complete quote")

`source_app`

Which app they came from — **929 missing**

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insured_address_state	Province — 855 missing
insured_email	Hashed/anonymized email (used as a customer ID)
Industry Code / Category	Business classification — 1,211 missing
Premium columns (Crime, Earthquake, etc.)	Dollar amounts — 7,398 missing (75%!)
Total Premium	Final quoted price — same 7,398 missing
rejection	Whether the quote was rejected (1.0) or not (0.0) — 4,325 missing
rejection_log	Reason for rejection
google_place_id, links	Location lookup data

● **Incomplete rows** — person stopped partway, so rejection and all premium columns are empty. That's normal.

● **Rejected rows** — person finished the quote but was turned down. Premium columns are empty, rejection = 1.

● **Complete/Quoted rows** — person finished AND was accepted. All premium columns have values, rejection = 0.